

Shortening numbered headings in header/footer using a custom character style

Introduction

Interoperability developments by **Skyler Grey** (Collabora Productivity, UK), **Michael Stahl** (allotropia, Germany) and **László Németh** (Csevej, Hungary) allow shortening the numbered headings for header/footer:

- to refer only the **beginning** of the headings in a **fully interoperable way**,
- to refer the beginning and extend it **with an ellipsis** or arbitrary other characters **a semi-interoperable way** (the ellipsis is not visible in MSO),
- to shorten the heading **with arbitrary text** using **file-level interoperability** (the replacement text is not visible in MSO, but it's possible to edit the DOCX document in Word without losing the custom short heading in Writer).

Two fields in the header for numbering and shortening

- A Styles field (STYLEREF in DOCX) **referring the number** of the paragraph which contains the text formatted with “Heading 1 Character”. Use always the custom character style, here, not the default paragraph style, e.g. “Heading 1 Character” instead of “Heading 1” – otherwise the interoperability is not guaranteed,
- A Styles field referring to the content of text formatted with “Heading 1 Character”.

Formatting of headings in the body text

- Short headings are formatted completely also with the referred character style, here “Heading 1” with “Heading 1 Character”;
- Long headings are formatted only at the beginning by the referred character style, shortening their text for the formatted part;
- If the beginning needs optional ellipsis in the header, there is a hidden ellipsis after the beginning, still formatted with the referred character style;